Living-Documentation Cleanup

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1 Objective and outcome

The objective was to remove obsolete and redundant material from the mutable project documentation without weakening its contracts, provenance, or resume value. The cleanup is complete. `PROGRESS.md` fell from 411 to 78 lines, and `docs/scheduling-parity-ledger.md` fell from 597 to 457 lines. Across the two files, the change removes 562 lines and adds 89.

No solver source, benchmark artifact, frozen design snapshot, historical report, or documentation checker changed. No whole documentation file was deleted.

2 Decisions and rationale

- `PROGRESS.md` is now only the current resume surface. Old rank-by-rank investigation diaries, the duplicated pre-Phase-4.5 debug contract, and the duplicated later-phase roadmap were removed because their durable owners are the development plan, frozen benchmark reports, design snapshots, and the scheduling ledger.
- The progress file retains the current Phase-4 exit state, the six closed Tier-D ranks, the fourteen open ranks, the latest soundness evidence, open gates, immediate work, and the machine-parsed scheduling markers.
- Only the mutable N4 verification tail of the scheduling ledger was compacted. Superseded "validation pending" chronology and rejected candidate diaries were replaced by the accepted final disposition, checked job provenance, later proof-soundness evidence, and explicit reopening conditions.
- Frozen design documents and reports were retained because they preserve distinct evidence and historical provenance. All parser anchors, ledger row identifiers, option-accounting sections, and policy boundaries were retained.

3 Validation and provenance

This is a documentation-only authority cleanup; the solver binary and its behavior are unchanged, so solver integration gates were not rerun. Measured results from the full documentation checker suite are: zero citation errors, zero section-reference errors (80/80 references resolved), zero progress errors or warnings, 28/28 inventory entries accounted for, 418/418 reference options accounted for, and no failures in proof-rule synchronization, configuration wiring, default-strategy configuration, effort specifications, statistic identifiers, comment hygiene, or rule/policy boundaries.

The size checker also passes. It reports two non-failing reserve warnings: `docs/calculus.md` is 635/680 lines and `docs/implementation-notes.md` is 559/560 lines. Those files were not edited because this audit found no safely removable current content in them.

4 Limitations and risks

The cleanup deliberately does not rewrite immutable evidence or attempt a second semantic consolidation of the calculus and implementation notes. Historical debugging detail removed from the live progress surface remains in the cited frozen campaign reports and repository history. The main ongoing risk is future duplication between the progress file and its authoritative owners; the new ownership preamble and existing size checker make that drift visible.

An independent Claude review was requested under the normal documentation workflow, but the external-service handoff was unavailable under the active data-export policy. The user explicitly approved proceeding with the local audit and diagnosis.

5 Next actions

Resume the development plan from the concise `PROGRESS.md` surface: keep rank 22 parked for now, investigate another open Tier-D rank under the pre-Phase-4.5 contract, and leave N4 closed unless a documented reopening condition occurs.